A SCORECARD FOR FOUNDERS · MARKETING-LEADER POSTING

Score the posting before it goes live.

Open the posting as it reads today and tick each line that is true. Under every line is what to change if it isn't. Score it with your sales leader in the room.

01 ☐ **The posting names the one number the role owns, and it is pipeline or revenue rather than MQLs or awareness.**

IF NOT Add one sentence: "This role owns pipeline created (or revenue sourced), reported monthly." If you can't choose the number yet, choosing it is your first job, before the posting goes up.

02 ☐ **It says who the role reports to and who sets the marketing budget.**

IF NOT Name the manager and the person who approves spend. If the budget isn't set, give a range for the first two quarters. A candidate will ask in the first interview either way.

03 ☐ **It describes the systems the role runs (CRM, automation, scoring, routing, the scoreboard) rather than the assets it produces.**

IF NOT List the systems by name: your CRM, the automation tool, how leads are scored and routed, the report the board reads. Say which exist today and which the hire will build.

04 ☐ **The headcount under the role is stated, and it was set after deciding what AI now covers.**

IF NOT Describe the team as it is on day one: direct reports, agencies, contractors, and the work AI tools already do. "No direct reports in year one" is a good answer once it is written down.

05 ☐ **It names the AI tools already in the stack and who owns them today.**

IF NOT List the AI tools the company pays for and who uses each one now. If nobody owns them, say the role will, and say whether there is a review step before anything they produce is published.

06 ☐ **It says what the first ninety days are for, and the answer is something other than "assess."**

IF NOT Write three outcomes for day ninety that someone could check. For example: the lead definition is signed by sales, the scoreboard is live with baselines, one campaign is in market.

07 ☐ **It names the regulations the function operates under and who signs off on a claim before it ships.**

IF NOT Name the rules that apply to your marketing (NACHA, FINRA, HIPAA, FERPA, state procurement rules) and who approves a claim before it is published. If none apply, say so. Candidates from regulated companies will ask.

08 ☐ **It asks for evidence that a function the candidate built kept running after they left.**

IF NOT Add one application question: "Tell us about something you built that was still running a year after you left it." It works in a final-round interview too.

09 ☐ **A written definition of a qualified lead, agreed by sales, exists before the hire.**

IF NOT Write one paragraph: who qualifies, which signal counts, what sales does with a qualified lead and how fast. Ask your sales lead to sign it. Without it, the hire negotiates it in their first quarter, with less standing than you have today.

10 ☐ **The sales leader has read the posting and agreed to it.**

IF NOT Send the posting to whoever runs sales with one question: "Would you commit to the number in this posting?" Edit it together until the answer is yes.

8 TO 10

Post it.

The posting describes a job a strong candidate can say yes to. Fix the remaining lines if they are quick, and keep the three interview questions below for the final round.

5 TO 7

Fix the posting first.

About half of the role is defined. Work through the open lines before the posting goes up. Most take one conversation. The lead definition and the budget owner take the longest, so start with those two.

0 TO 4

The posting is asking for two jobs.

As written, one person is asked to build the marketing function and to run it. Those are different jobs, and often different people. Decide which one this posting is for, then rewrite it around that job. The open lines are the list of what still has to be built.

THREE LINES THAT WORK AS FINAL-ROUND QUESTIONS

"Which one number would you want to own here, and how would you report it to the board?"

"What would you have finished by day ninety?"

"What did you build that was still running a year after you left it?"

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